Đắk Som, Tà Đùng commune, Lâm Đồng

Here El Niño arrives as a dry season that empties wells, and the first job is to write down, hamlet by hamlet, who will have no water in March.

PROVINCE (TRACKER)	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Đắk Nông, pre-2025 boundaries (now part of Lâm Đồng)	40 forecast, 13 of them in March; 38 already past (Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Dry-season drought and water shortage, then diarrhoea, dengue, and forest fire

16/16 recommendations checked. 10 corrected, 0 unverified, 6 contraindicated (the six "Do not do this" cards; one of them, about house churches, was found in verification). All 9 For you steps were checked too, and 3 were corrected. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for the former Đắk Nông province, not for this commune, and it counts heat only. Drought, diarrhoea, dengue, and fire are this place's larger risks and are carried here by the record, not by a number. Đắk Som stopped being a commune on 1 July 2025. It and Đắk R'Măng now form Tà Đùng commune, whose office sits in the former Đắk Som, so every local action here is addressed to Tà Đùng. The funding target fell from the panel's VND 1.32 billion (US$51,500) to VND 1.05 billion (US$40,960)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



11.95°N 107.99°E, Vietnam · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** In 2016 Đắk Nông had about 36,000 people without household water, and Đắk Som's nine piped water schemes have all stopped working.
- **For you.** By 30 November, tell your village head (trưởng thôn) where your water comes from, so your hamlet is on the tanker list. It costs nothing.
- **The money.** VND 300 million to 1.88 billion (US$11,700–73,100); the health station's VND 60 million buys the most lives.
- **Do not.** Do not borrow VND 30–40 million to drill deeper wells in December–February; in past droughts here, wells came up dry.

For you, as a resident	9 steps	p. 2
What to do	**10** actions	p. 5
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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

after verification (−20%), because only about 200–250 poor households remain in the former Đắk Som and 50 already received water containers under Programme 1719.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT

9 STEPS

For a family in the former Đắk Som, El Niño means the well or the stream pipe failing between February and April, while the coffee is flowering and needs water too. Diarrhoea and dengue follow when water is short and stored badly. The ranked actions below are written for the commune and its partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

Tell your village head where your water comes from, and whether it failed last dry season

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 November 2026	none	household drinking water

Lâm Đồng's dry-season water plan promises tanker trucks "so residents are not left without water for long", but it counts reservoirs, not households, and names none of the former Đắk Nông communes. If your household is not on the commune's list, the tanker has no reason to come up your track. Families living out in field huts (chòi rẫy), and families who have not registered with the commune, are the most likely to be missed.

Check you are still on the poor or near-poor list after the merger, and ask to be assessed as food-short if rice runs low

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
14 December 2026	none	relief rice, loans, school support

The 2026 household review is running now, and the merger of Đắk Som into Tà Đùng is when families fall off lists. Relief rice from the national reserve (15 kg per person per month, for up to three months) goes to households assessed as food-short (hộ thiếu đói). Being poor does not qualify a household by itself, so ask for the assessment as soon as your rice runs low.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Fill a 1,000-litre tank with a tight lid before the rains end, and scrub it every week

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 December 2026	VND 2.3–4.1 million (US$89–160)	drinking water; children from dengue

A tank filled in December carries a family through the weeks between a dry well and a tanker. An open jar breeds the mosquitoes that carry dengue: the province had 2,289 cases in the first seven months of 2024. If you cannot pay cash, the Social Policy Bank (VBSP) lends up to VND 25 million (US$975) per water works at 9% a year for up to five years, with no collateral, through your village savings-and-loan group (Decision 10/2024/QĐ-TTg). Apply now, because the money arrives only when the commune's allocation does.

Agree with your neighbours now to share the wells that still give water: drinking water first, crops second

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 December 2026	none	household water; savings

In past Central Highlands droughts, families raced to drill deeper, and many wells still came up dry. Others bought water from neighbours at VND 50,000 (US$2) an hour. A sharing rule agreed before the shortage costs nothing. Once the drilling rush starts, it is too late to agree one.

When you sell the coffee, buy the rice for March to May, and store it sealed

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
at the coffee sale, November–December	50 kg about VND 750,000–900,000 (US$29–35); local price unverified	food in the hungry months

Rice prices are flat (down 0.06% in September) and robusta is near VND 89,000 a kilogram, so this harvest's cash goes further now than it will in the lean months. Waiting saves almost nothing, and the cash gets spent elsewhere. Keep the rice in a sealed drum against

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

weevils.

From February, boil or chlorinate drinking water, and keep ten packets of oral rehydration salts at home*

CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
31 January 2027	about VND 15,000 (US$0.60) for 10 ORS packets	young children and older people

Chlorinating water at home cuts diarrhoea by about a third (Wolf et al., *Lancet* 2022, relative risk 0.66). Oral rehydration salts (ORS) are what keep a child with diarrhoea alive until help arrives. In 2020, 21.3% of young children in Đắk Glong were stunted, and stunted children are the ones diarrhoea kills.*

Check your health insurance card is valid

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 November 2026	free for poor households and for especially difficult areas; otherwise 4.5% of the base salary	the cost of treatment

Check the card on the VssID app or at the commune office. Whether Tà Đùng is on the 2026–2030 list of especially difficult areas, which makes the card free for residents, could not be confirmed. Ask at the commune office rather than assuming.

In March and April, do heavy field work before 10 a.m. and after 4 p.m., and look in on older neighbours*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
March–April 2027	none	outdoor workers; older people living alone

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

March is the forecast's peak month for heat deaths in the province (13 of 40). The Ministry of Health's El Niño heat guidance (26 May 2026) says to stay out of the sun from 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. and to wear a hat and loose clothes. Đắk Som is upland, so very hot days are fewer here than in the lowlands. The people at risk are the ones irrigating coffee at midday and older people on their own.*

Do not burn fields on days the forest rangers forecast fire danger at level IV or V*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
January–April 2027	none	home, crops, the forest

In 2024 Đắk Glong had 21 of the province's 26 forest fires. Lâm Đồng already bans burning vegetation at fire-danger levels IV and V. Ask your village head for the day's level before you clear a plot.*

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask the commune disaster-prevention committee whether your hamlet is on the tanker route, and what declaration releases the water (action 3).
- Ask Tà Đùng commune who now owns your bon's broken water scheme, and whether it is on any repair list (action 10).
- Ask the commune health station when the village health workers will start their February house visits, and whether chlorine tablets will reach your hamlet (action 2).
- Ask your coffee cooperative or buyer whether Lâm Đồng will subsidise weather-index crop insurance under the new Decree 346/2026 (action 9).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

independently is the stronger bet.

1. Walk every hamlet of the former Đắk Som and list each household with no working piped water, including field-hut and unregistered families

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · FOOD · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng People's Committee, with village heads and the Women's Union	30 November 2026	staff time	tankers and tanks going to the wrong hamlets in March

Lâm Đồng's 2026–27 dry-season plan (30 September) asks for 1,031.5 billion VND for 148 reservoirs and calls for a review of households at risk of water shortage. It gives no household count and does not name Tà Đùng. The register is the precondition for actions 3 and 4: it is not protective by itself, and no study shows that a register saves lives. Flag which households lost water in 2024–25. The press has no record of it for Đắk Som, so the walk has to find it.

Corrected in verification: the national ministry's 18 August directive is addressed to the central coast, the southeast, and the Mekong Delta, not to the Central Highlands. The basis for this register is the province's own instruction.

2. Stock ORS, zinc, and chlorine tablets at the commune health station, and send village health workers to young children and isolated older people from February

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng commune health station	Stock by 31 January 2027; visits February–April	VND 60 million (US$2,340)	child deaths from diarrhoea; heat illness in older people

Pooled studies put the cut in child diarrhoea deaths from ORS at about 69%, at roughly 74% coverage (Munos et al. 2010; very low-quality evidence, from three studies). Chlorinating water at home cuts diarrhoea risk by a third (Wolf et al. 2022, relative risk 0.66). The station and its village health workers already make home visits to older and immobile people (Nhân Dân, March 2026). ORS costs about VND

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

1,500 a sachet and a zinc course VND 22,000–30,000, so VND 60 million covers the station's stock. It covers chlorine for priority households only, not for every household for three months.

Transferability: the diarrhoea evidence comes from low- and middle-income countries broadly, not from Vietnam. The heat benefit is plausible but unquantified here: Vietnam's heat-mortality effect is measured on days with a mean above 30°C, which are rare in the uplands. In this commune, the diarrhoea case is stronger than the heat case.

3. Agree tanker routes, fill points, and a release trigger now, asking the fire police or army to deliver first and holding cash for private hauliers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng disaster-prevention committee (Ban chỉ huy PCTT)	**31 December 2026; release when listed wells are declared dry**	**reserve of VND 240 million (US$9,360)**	**weeks without drinking water in March–April**

The provincial plan already requires tankers "when needed" but sets no trigger, routes, or fill points. In 2020 the Central Highlands precedent was free delivery: in Ea Súp, fire trucks brought 24,000 litres to about 200 households. The reserve covers private hauliers for 300 households × 8 m³ × about VND 100,000 per m³, the price of trucked water in Kon Tum in 2017. Hold it, and release it only when the trigger fires.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: the panel's VND 150,000 per m³ had no source. There is no outcome evidence that trucked water cuts deaths, and no record was found of tankers being used in Đắk Glong before.

4. Give 1,000-litre tanks with tight lids to about 250 poor, water-short households, with chlorine guidance and monthly larva checks

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng People's Committee, delivered by the Women's Union	15 December 2026	VND 750 million (US$29,250)	water running out between the well and the tanker; dengue in stored water

The model is the 14 October 2026 handover of 450 tanks of 1,000 litres in three Đắk Lắk communes, by the Ministry of Agriculture and Environment, Đắk Lắk province, and UNICEF. No such programme was found for Lâm Đồng, so ask the provincial department to include Tà Đùng. Exclude the 50 Đắk Som and Đắk Plao households that already received containers under Programme 1719. At the end of 2024, about 9.6% of Tà Đùng households were poor, or roughly 200–250 in the former Đắk Som, so 250 tanks reaches the poor households. Cost: 250 × VND 3 million, against retail prices of VND 2.29–4.09 million.

Corrected in verification: the cited mortality meta-analysis (Kremer et al. 2022) is about chlorination, not storage, so tanks save lives only when paired with treatment. Lids are necessary against dengue but not proven sufficient (Bowman et al. 2016), hence the larva checks.

5. Give every warning in Mông as well as Vietnamese, through prestige persons, the Sunday market, and Zalo voice notes, with weekly buddy checks in March–April

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng Fatherland Front committee, with prestige persons (người có uy tín) and village heads	from November 2026; buddy checks March–April 2027	near zero	warnings that never reach the people at most risk

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Tà Đùng has 4,397 households, and 1,935 of them, 13,595 people, are Mông: the largest Mông community in Lâm Đồng, who came from Hà Giang, Lào Cai, Cao Bằng, and Lai Châu (VietnamPlus, June 2026). The Sunday-morning Đắk R'Măng market is where they gather. No Mông-language broadcasting was found in the Central Highlands, so record short voice notes locally and share them in thôn Zalo groups. A volunteer checks five to ten field-hut, elderly, or unregistered households a week. Use registered church congregations only, and only where their leaders opt in (see "Do not do this").

Transferability: the evidence that trusted messengers in people's own language raise protective action is moderate and comes mainly from COVID campaigns among minority groups in the UK. Lâm Đồng already uses ethnic languages and prestige persons in its outreach, but has published no results.

6. Re-check the poor and food-short lists after the merger, and file the December relief-rice request with Tà Đùng named in it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Lâm Đồng People's Committee, with Tà Đùng commune	Commune list by 14 December 2026; provincial request in December	staff time; rice from the national reserve	hunger in the March–May lean months

Under Decree 20/2021, food-short households get 15 kg of rice per person per month, for up to three months a round. Lâm Đồng received 416.8 tonnes for the early-2026 lean season, handed over on 3–5 February, so the request had to be filed in late 2025. Đắk Nông drew 163 tonnes in 2020 and 171 tonnes in 2024.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: eligibility is a food shortage (below about 9 kg of rice per person per month), not poverty alone, and a January filing would miss the Tết round. Rice markets are stable, which favours cash, but the national reserve gives only rice, so the request stands.

7. Set lookout rosters and firebreaks before Tết, and hold the province's no-burn rule on level IV and V fire-danger days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Tà Đùng People's Committee, with the forest rangers (Kiểm lâm) and Tà Đùng National Park	before Tết (6 February 2027), through April	existing forest-fire (PCCCR) budget	field burns turning into forest fires

Đắk Glong had 21 of Đắk Nông's 26 forest fires in 2024, including about 20 ha in Quảng Sơn in April. Tà Đùng National Park covers about 20,900 ha, mostly natural forest. Lâm Đồng Decision 37/2026 sets fire-danger levels I–V, with forecasts at commune level, and burning vegetation is banned at levels IV and V. The elders' agreement enforces an existing rule rather than creating a new one.

Corrected in verification: the 20,900 ha is the park's whole area, not a zone officially flagged as high fire risk.

8. Issue the provincial disaster notice as soon as drought losses pass 30%, so bank debt can be frozen and Decree 09 support assessed quickly

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Lâm Đồng People's Committee, with VBSP, Agribank, and the commune assessment team	plan by February 2027; act on the trigger	staff time; support paid from the provincial budget	distress sales of land and harvest to repay loans

Decree 09/2025 pays VND 10 million per ha (US$390) for a 30–70% loss on a producing orchard and VND 20 million (US$780) above 70%; it pays more if the trees die. Since Decree 53/2026, claims go straight from commune to province. Under Decree 156/2025 and the VBSP rules (Decision 50/2010 as amended by 08/2021), debt can be extended or frozen only after the provincial People's Committee

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

declares the disaster. Đắk Glong had about 5,500 VBSP borrowers owing about VND 305 billion in April 2025.

Corrected in verification: the trigger is the provincial notice, not a commune agreement, and a pre-season photo list can speed up assessment but is not required. In 2024 the province asked the centre for VND 377 billion against more than VND 440 billion of losses, and no record was found that the centre granted it.

9. Ask the provincial People's Council to switch on index-insurance subsidies for coffee, and ask FAO to add the former Đắk Nông to its drought assessment

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Lâm Đồng People's Council (HĐND)	before flowering, January 2027	premiums unpublished; unfunded until the council sets rates	a lost 2027/28 harvest becoming household debt

Decree 346/2026 (in force 20 October 2026) subsidises up to 95% of agricultural insurance premiums for poor and near-poor households and 50% for other individuals. It covers weather-index products, but the provincial People's Council decides which areas, crops, and risks, and Lâm Đồng has not yet decided. The only coffee index cover in Vietnam (WTW, Bảo Minh, and the Natural Disaster Fund) is in Gia Lai, sold through supply chains, with no payouts disclosed. FAO's drought early-action triggers cover only the Mekong Delta and Gia Lai. FAO is now recruiting for a 2026 Central Highlands drought assessment, which is the way in.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: there is no Viet Nam Red Cross early-action protocol for drought; the only Vietnamese protocol is for heatwaves in Hà Nội, Hải Phòng, and Đà Nẵng. Whether individual smallholders can buy index cover is unverified. This action protects next year's income more than this year's lives.

10. Assess Đắk Som's nine dead piped-water schemes, and repair only those with a named operator and an agreed user fee

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Lâm Đồng People's Committee (provincial rural water centre), with Tà Đùng commune	**assessment by 31 January 2027; repairs after the peak**	**not costed for Đắk Som**	**the next El Niño finding the same hamlets dry**

All nine schemes in Đắk Som were built in 2004–07, and none works (Báo Lâm Đồng, July 2024). In the old Đắk Glong district only 5 of 43 were running. The cause given was management, with nobody responsible for upkeep, not sources drying up. The precedent for a scheme that lasts is Cư Đrăm in Đắk Lắk: households paid VND 2.5–4 million each for a gravity system they run themselves, and it has not run dry since 2008.

Corrected in verification: do not count on any scheme working by February 2027. The province's VND 100 billion to repair 36 schemes was a request, not a budget, and no list shows whether Đắk Som is in it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Tà Đùng People's Committee	Commune health station	Commune PCTT committee	Women's Union	Fatherland Front and prestige persons	Lâm Đồng People's Committee	Lâm Đồng People's Council	Kiểm lâm and Tà Đùng National Park	VBSP and Agribank
1. Household water register	**A/R**	**C**	**I**	**R**	**R**	**I**			
2. Health station stock and visits	**C**	**A/R**		**C**	**I**				
3. Tanker routes and trigger	**C**		**A/R**	**I**	**I**	**C**			
4. Lidded tanks for poor households	**A**	**C**		**R**	**C**	**C**			
5. Warnings in Mông	**C**	**C**		**R**	**A/R**				
6. Lists and relief rice	**R**			**C**	**C**	**A**			
7. Fire watch and no-burn days	**A**		**C**		**C**			**R**	
8. Disaster notice, debt freeze, Decree 09	**R**					**A**			**R**
9. Index insurance and FAO	**I**					**R**	**A**		**C**
10. Repair dead water schemes	**R**				**C**	**A**			

What the chart shows: Tà Đùng People's Committee carries the most rows (eight). The province is accountable for the four that need a decision rather than money (relief rice, the disaster notice, scheme repairs, and, through its People's Council, insurance). Actions 1, 5, 6, and 8 cost staff time only; they need someone to decide, not a budget.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

VND 300 million (US$11,700)

TARGET

VND 1.05 billion (US$40,960)

CEILING

VND 1.875 billion (US$73,140)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

How many households lose their water source; the register (action 1) answers it

Floor = health station VND 60 million + tanker reserve VND 240 million = VND 300 million. Target = floor + 250 tanks × VND 3 million (VND 750 million) = VND 1.05 billion. Ceiling = target + cash of VND 1.5 million to 250 households (VND 375 million) + 150 more tanks for near-poor

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

households (VND 450 million) = VND 1.875 billion. Above that, a former commune of perhaps 1,600 households cannot absorb more before the peak. The target fell 20% in verification, from the panel's VND 1.32 billion.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Tà Đùng commune health station	Action 2: ORS, zinc, chlorine for priority households, house visits	VND 60 million (US$2,340)	pre-positioned stock	ORS cuts child diarrhoea deaths by about 69% (Munos 2010, very low quality); household chlorination about US$53 per DALY averted (WHO 2008, indicative)	Partially confirmed
Tà Đùng disaster-prevention committee	Action 3: private tanker hire, released on the trigger	VND 240 million (US$9,360)	pre-arranged reserve, released on a trigger	300 households × 8 m³ × VND 100,000 per m³ (Kon Tum, 2017); no outcome evidence	Partially confirmed
Tà Đùng People's Committee, through the Women's Union	Action 4: 250 lidded 1,000-litre tanks	VND 750 million (US$29,250)	direct grant	Retail VND 2.29–4.09 million per tank; no Women's Union record at this scale found	Partially confirmed
Tà Đùng People's Committee or Viet Nam Red Cross	Cash to the 250 poorest households (ceiling only)	VND 375 million (US$14,630)	cash transfer	Prevents distress borrowing; saves the fewest lives per đồng; no local cash precedent found	Unverified
Tà Đùng People's Committee, through the Women's Union	Action 4 extended: 150 tanks for near-poor households (ceiling only)	VND 450 million (US$17,550)	direct grant	As above	Partially confirmed

A funder's view: at the tracker's rate, Tà Đùng's share of Đắk Nông's 40 forecast heat deaths is between one and two (our arithmetic: 40 × 23,944 people ÷ roughly 650,000–680,000 in the old province). Lives per đồng here cannot compete with Bhola or Kafouri. Fund the VND 60 million health line for lives. Fund water as protection against illness, debt, and lost harvests, and be honest that this is what it buys.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Borrowing VND 30–40 million to drill a deeper well in December–February

CONTRAINDICATED

In past droughts, Krông Nô farmers lost all three of their wells or drilled seven, and in Cư Jút 500–600 rigs ran at once. In Đắk Lắk, unlicensed pumping dropped the water table about 7 m in 2010–14. The household ends up with the debt and no water.

Instead: agree now to share the wells that still give water, drinking water first; borrow, if at all, for a tank (For you, step 3).

Building another piped water scheme without a named owner and a user fee

CONTRAINDICATED

Đắk Som already has nine piped schemes, built in 2004–07, and none works. One at bon B'Srê B is covered in vines. Across the old province 188 of 262 schemes had stopped. A new scheme with nobody responsible for upkeep is likely to become the tenth.

Instead: repair the existing schemes only where an operator and a fee are agreed first (action 10), and put this season's money into tanks and tankers.

Flooding the whole coffee or durian orchard to save it, ahead of drinking water

CONTRAINDICATED

Farmers here apply 600–700 litres per tree per watering, of which 300–400 litres is wasted, and only about 27% of farmland is irrigated at all. In April 2024, 31 of the province's irrigation works ran dry while households went short of drinking water.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: keep drinking water first, and water fewer trees properly.

Storing water in open jars or tanks

CONTRAINDICATED

Đắk Nông recorded 2,289 dengue cases between January and July 2024. In rural Vietnam, dengue risk is linked to the lack of piped water, and so to water stored at home (Schmidt et al. 2011).

Instead: put a tight lid on every container, scrub it weekly, and check it for larvae.

Warning only in Vietnamese, or only over the commune loudspeaker

CONTRAINDICATED

More than half of Tà Đùng is Mông, many of whom do not read Vietnamese. The households at most risk live out in field huts or are unregistered, beyond the loudspeaker and off the lists.

Instead: warn in Mông, through prestige persons, the Sunday market, and Zalo voice notes, with buddy checks (action 5).

Routing warnings through unregistered house churches, or listing them

CONTRAINDICATED

Found in verification. Many migrant Mông are Protestant, and independent house churches in the Central Highlands still face detention and pressure (RFA, 2024). A commune programme that visibly coordinates with unregistered congregations, or writes them down, could expose the people it is meant to protect.

Instead: work only with registered congregations whose leaders opt in, and never list or map unregistered groups.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE

THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2004–07	Nine piped clean-water schemes built in Đắk Som	All nine out of service by 2024	Nothing: no owner for upkeep
2015–16 (El Niño)	Drought across Đắk Nông; Đắk Glong among the five hardest-hit districts	About 7,750 households (36,000 people) without household water; 20,891 ha of coffee and pepper lost 30–70% of yield; about VND 1,020 billion in losses	Funding requested for the Đắk N'Ting reservoir in Đắk Glong
August 2019	Wet-season floods across the province; the Đắk Sin 1 penstock ruptured	5 dead; about VND 120 billion	Not recorded
2019–20	Drought, mainly Krông Nô and Đắk Mil	About 24,900 ha damaged; 672 households without water	163 tonnes of relief rice to Đắk Nông (Decision 267/QĐ-TTg)
July 2023	Floods after Typhoon Doksuri; landslide at the Đắk N'Ting reservoir	25 houses in Đắk Glong cut off and evacuated; state of emergency	The 2016 drought fix became a wet-season hazard
2024 (El Niño)	Drought and forest fires	More than VND 440 billion in losses; 21 of the province's 26 forest fires in Đắk Glong	VND 377 billion requested from the centre, with no record of a grant; 171 tonnes of relief rice

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the water infrastructure each drought produces is built late, often on cleared slopes, and then fails. The 2016 drought produced the Đắk N'Ting reservoir, which by 2023 was a landslide emergency. Meanwhile the migrant hamlets it was meant to serve are still outside it, and each El Niño finds the same households unserved. No death in Đắk Som itself was found in the record.

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WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Build gravity-fed water before December** (Historian, on the Cư Đrăm precedent) versus **build nothing new until the nine dead schemes have owners** (Skeptic). Verification sided with the Skeptic for this season: nothing can be built and run before February. Who is right in the long run depends on whether a household-run scheme like Cư Đrăm's can be set up here.
- **Spend on water** (Emergency manager, Historian) versus **spend on the health line, because that is where lives are** (Philanthropist). Both hold: water spending prevents illness and debt, and the health station prevents deaths. The register will show how many households actually lose water.
- **Cash** (rice markets are stable and well supplied) versus **rice in kind** (the national reserve gives only rice). Kept as both: rice through the state channel, and cash at the ceiling.
- **Heat warnings for older people** (Public health, on the Ahmedabad plan) versus **heat is minor in the uplands** (verification: Vietnam's heat effect is measured on days with a mean above 30°C, which are rare here). Station temperature data for Tà Đùng would settle it.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens examined the hydropower reservoirs around the commune (Đồng Nai 3 and 4, Đắk R'tih): how they are run in the dry season, or what an emergency release would do to the hamlets below them in the wet season. No lens heard from a Mông resident directly. Every source on how this community works is provincial or press-based, and the newest Đắk Som-specific data is from 2014.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are published at province scale here, for the former Đắk Nông, about 650,000 people. They are not commune figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Scope.** The location was given as Đắk Som, Vietnam. Đắk Som was a commune of the former Đắk Glong district, Đắk Nông province. Under Resolution 1671/NQ-UBTVQH15 (16 June 2025, in force 1 July 2025), it merged with Đắk R'Măng to form Tà Đùng commune, Lâm Đồng province: 4,397 households, 23,944 people. The briefing covers the former Đắk Som (7,221 people in 2014, the latest figure found) and addresses its actions to Tà Đùng. Mortality figures exist only at province level; commune detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Đắk Nông (GADM VNM.16_1, pre-2025 boundaries), 38 additional heat deaths June–September 2026, 40 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October 4, November 5, December 5, January 6, February 9, March 13), 78 in total; Vietnam, 18,100; the world, 857,400. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month. They are never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections. The Tà Đùng share in the funding section is our arithmetic, not a tracker finding.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources in Vietnamese and English, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist; food actions for published triggers and timing. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted in this run. The browse page loads its data in the browser, and on earlier runs its "Download Inventory" link led to a registration form. No action here should be read as having no precedent; none was checked.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in Vietnamese đồng with US dollars in parentheses, at VND 25,637 = US$1 (State Bank of Vietnam central rate, 30 October 2026, as reported by VOV).
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. Its steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about households here. Any step not drawn from a ranked action was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the commune and its partners.
- **Language.** A Vietnamese version accompanies this one, because Vietnamese is the language of local government. More than half of Tà Đùng speaks Mông at home, and no Mông version was made: Mông is written in a romanised script, but there is too little written material to produce safety instructions a Mông reader would trust. Action 5 asks the commune to record the key messages as Mông voice notes instead.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (water treatment, oral rehydration salts, heat, and fire) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The tracker's province no longer exists: Đắk Nông merged into Lâm Đồng on 1 July 2025, and the data uses the old boundary. No Đắk Som-specific drought, death, or water-shortage record was found after 2014, so most evidence is for the province or the old district. The full texts of Lâm Đồng Decision 37/2026 and Decree 53/2026 were not read. Prices for tanks, retail rice, and trucked water rest on retail listings or other provinces. The locator map marks Tà Đùng commune at country scale; the boundary of the former Đắk Som is not drawn.

References · status after verification

Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); tracker · confirmed
Administrative change: Resolution 1671/NQ-UBTVQH15; VietnamPlus, Đắk R'Măng market, Jun 2026; Đại biểu Nhân dân, Tà Đùng; poverty rates; Đắk Som

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

2014 baseline · confirmed

Water: Lâm Đồng 2026–27 dry-season plan; ministry directive, 18 Aug 2026; Đắk Som's nine schemes; SGGP, 36-scheme request; Cư Đrăm gravity water; Kon Tum trucked water price; Ea Súp fire-truck delivery; UNICEF tanks, Đắk Lắk; Programme 1719 containers; well failures, PLO; IWMI groundwater; over-irrigation · partially confirmed

Record: 2016 drought; 2016 households without water; 2020 drought; 2020 and 2024 damage; 2019 floods; 2023 floods; Đắk N'Ting emergency; 2024 losses; 2024 request · confirmed (the grant: not found)

Health: Munos et al. 2010; Wolf et al. 2022; Kremer et al. 2022; Hess et al. 2018; Nguyen et al. 2023; Đắk Glong stunting; Tà Đùng home visits; dengue 2024; Bowman et al. 2016; Decree 188/2025; ORS price; MoH heat dispatch, 26 May 2026 · partially confirmed

Outreach and fire: Lâm Đồng ethnic-language outreach; UK minority-communication review; RFA, house churches; Tà Đùng fire prevention; 2024 fires; Decision 37/2026 · partially confirmed

Food and money: Lâm Đồng relief rice 2026; Decree 20/2021 rates; Decision 267/QĐ-TTg; Decision 465/QĐ-TTg; 2026 poverty review; NSO CPI, Sep 2026; robusta price; Decree 09/2025; Decree 156/2025; Decision 08/2021; Đắk Glong VBSP lending; VBSP clean-water loans; Decree 346/2026; WTW coffee index cover; FAO anticipatory action; UNICEF El Niño 2026–27; Viet Nam heatwave EAP; SBV rate, VOV, 30 Oct 2026 · partially confirmed

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 30 October 2026 for Đắk Som, Tà Đùng commune, Lâm Đồng. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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